Adrian Castellanos

Senior Software Engineer

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About

Senior software engineer with 8+ years of experience designing and operating distributed backend systems at scale. Specialized in **Go** and **Rust** services, Kubernetes platforms, and developer tooling. Led the migration of a payments platform to an event-driven architecture handling 40k requests per second at 99.99% availability. Looking for a staff-level role building reliable cloud infrastructure.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer | Nimbravo Systems — Los Angeles, CA ..... 03/2023 – Present

- Lead a 6-engineer team owning the multi-region control plane for a managed Kubernetes offering running 2,000+ production clusters across 14 cloud regions.
- Designed a Raft-based configuration store in Go that cut cluster provisioning time from 11 to 3 minutes.
- Introduced OpenTelemetry tracing across 40 services, cutting mean time to resolution (MTTR) by 35%.
- Mentored 4 engineers to promotion; ran the backend interview loop.

Go – Kubernetes – etcd – Raft – OpenTelemetry – Prometheus – AWS – Helm – Envoy

Lumenquay Pay | San Francisco, CA ..... 06/2018 – 02/2023

> **Software Engineer II** | Payments Platform | 01/2021 – 02/2023
>
> - Led the migration from a monolithic Rails checkout to Go microservices over Kafka and gRPC, letting 12 teams release daily instead of every two weeks.
> - Built an idempotent ledger service processing $2B+ in annual volume; cut p99 checkout latency from 850 ms to 210 ms.
>
> Go – Kafka – gRPC – PostgreSQL – Redis – Terraform
>
> **Software Engineer I** | Checkout Team | 06/2018 – 12/2020
>
> Shipped the checkout SDK in TypeScript, adopted by 1,200+ merchants within its first year.
>
> TypeScript – Ruby on Rails – PostgreSQL – GraphQL

Software Engineering Intern | Orbitrove Labs — Remote ..... 06/2017 – 09/2017

- Implemented a Python CLI for reproducible ML experiment tracking, later open-sourced by the company.

Open-Source Projects

quill-kv | Embedded storage engine ..... 2022 – Present
Crash-safe LSM-tree key-value store with lock-free memtables; 2.3k GitHub stars, used in production by 3 companies. Source: github.com/adrian-castellanos-swe/quill-kv

kubectl-pulse | Kubernetes CLI tool 2021
A `kubectl` plugin streaming live namespace health to the terminal; in the Krew index with 15k+ installs.

Contributor to the Go standard library ..... 2020 – 2022
Six merged patches to `net/http` and `database/sql`, including a fix for connection-pool starvation under context cancellation.

Technical Skills

Languages: Go, Rust, Python, TypeScript, C, C++, SQL, Bash
Infrastructure & Tools: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS, GCP, PostgreSQL, Kafka, Redis, gRPC, Prometheus, Argo CD, Helm, Linux

Education

M.S. in Computer Science | University of California, Los Angeles ..... 09/2016 – 06/2018
B.S. in Computer Engineering, summa cum laude | University of California, Los Angeles ..... 09/2012 – 06/2016

Certifications

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | Cloud Native Computing Foundation 2024
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional | Amazon Web Services 2022

Talks & Languages

Zero-Downtime Control Plane Upgrades at Scale | KubeCon + CloudNativeCon NA 11/2025

English | Native
Spanish | Professional working proficiency (C1)